

Ἀντωνῖνος Λιβεράλις

Antoninus the Mythographer and the Collection of Metamorphoses

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Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)
Domain: Μυθιστορία [Fiction](#)
Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

Antoninus Liberalis is known solely as the author of the **Metamorphoses**. His precise dates, birthplace, and biographical details are unknown, though his name suggests a Roman context. He is traditionally placed in the late second or early third century CE, within the period of the Second Sophistic. His work indicates a learned, scholarly familiarity with earlier sources, but no specific personal information survives.

His only extant work is the **Metamorphoses**, a compilation of forty-one brief transformation myths drawn from earlier Hellenistic sources. Antoninus Liberalis is a significant compiler and transmitter of mythological narratives. His **Metamorphoses** preserves variants of myths and serves as a crucial witness to the content of now-lost Hellenistic works, particularly those of Nicander and Boeus, whom he cites. The collection reflects the antiquarian interests of his era and is a valuable source for understanding later Greek mythology.

Works (1)

- [Συναγωγή Μεταμορφώσεων](#) · [Collection of Metamorphoses](#) · 225 passages